

AI-DND

04_CHARACTER_SYSTEM.md

Character System Design Document

Version 0.1

1. CHARACTER PHILOSOPHY

The player is not a hero.

The player is not chosen.

The player begins as an ordinary person.

Power must be earned.

Knowledge must be learned.

Respect must be deserved.

2. CHARACTER CREATION

At the beginning of the game the player creates:

- name;
- gender;
- appearance;
- origin;
- personality tendencies.

The player does NOT choose:

- class;
- profession;
- destiny.

These emerge naturally during gameplay.

3. CHARACTER ORIGINS

Possible origins:

- Prisoner
- Mercenary
- Hunter
- Blacksmith Apprentice
- Farmer
- Refugee
- Soldier
- Thief
- Scholar
- Orphan

Origin determines:

- starting reputation;
 - knowledge;
 - equipment;
 - memories;
 - contacts.
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4. PRIMARY ATTRIBUTES

The game uses core attributes.

Strength

Affects:

- melee damage;
 - carrying capacity;
 - intimidation;
 - physical actions.
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Agility

Affects:

- initiative;

- accuracy;
 - evasion;
 - movement.
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Constitution

Affects:

- health;
 - stamina;
 - disease resistance;
 - poison resistance.
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Intelligence

Affects:

- learning speed;
 - investigation;
 - knowledge;
 - crafting.
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Willpower

Affects:

- magic resistance;
 - fear resistance;
 - mental stability.
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Charisma

Affects:

- persuasion;
 - leadership;
 - negotiation;
 - reputation.
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Perception

Affects:

- observation;
 - traps;
 - hidden objects;
 - enemy intentions.
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5. HIDDEN ATTRIBUTES

Characters also possess hidden traits.

Examples:

- bravery;
- greed;
- compassion;
- cruelty;
- curiosity;
- discipline;
- ambition.

These influence AI reactions.

6. EXPERIENCE

Characters gain:

Learning Points (LP)

LP are earned through:

- quests;
- discoveries;
- survival;
- combat;
- exploration;
- training.

LP are spent with teachers.

7. SKILLS

Skills are grouped.

Combat

- one-handed sword
 - two-handed sword
 - axes
 - maces
 - daggers
 - spears
 - bows
 - crossbows
 - shields
 - unarmed
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Magic

- fire
 - frost
 - arcane
 - spirit
 - blood
 - shadow
 - nature
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Survival

- hunting
 - tracking
 - cooking
 - camping
 - medicine
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Social

- persuasion
- deception
- intimidation

- bargaining
 - leadership
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Criminal

- lockpicking
 - pickpocketing
 - stealth
 - sabotage
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8. SKILL LEVELS

Untrained ↓ Novice ↓ Student ↓ Experienced ↓ Master ↓ Legend

Players see names, not numbers.

9. TRAINING

Skills cannot be learned automatically.

Requirements:

- teacher;
 - LP;
 - money;
 - reputation.
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10. REPUTATION

Three systems exist.

Personal Reputation

How individual NPCs see the player.

Local Reputation

How settlements view the player.

Faction Reputation

How organizations react.

11. FEAR

Characters develop fears.

Examples:

- fear of spiders;
 - fear of darkness;
 - fear of magic;
 - fear of dragons;
 - fear of death.
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12. TRAUMA

Traumatic experiences create:

- nightmares;
 - hesitation;
 - panic;
 - depression;
 - aggression.
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13. MORALITY

There is no morality meter.

Instead:

NPCs judge actions.

Example:

Murder:

- some hate you;
 - some respect you;
 - some fear you.
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14. HEALTH

Health consists of:

- body condition;
 - mental condition;
 - injuries;
 - diseases;
 - fatigue.
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15. BODY SYSTEM

Body zones:

- head;
- torso;
- left arm;
- right arm;
- left leg;
- right leg.

Each body part:

- may be injured;
 - may heal;
 - may become disabled.
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16. SCARS

Scars remain permanently.

Examples:

- burned face;
- missing eye;
- damaged hand;
- broken nose.

NPCs remember scars.

17. ADDICTIONS

Characters may develop addictions.

Examples:

- alcohol;
- drugs;
- magical substances.

Effects:

- benefits;
 - penalties;
 - social consequences.
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18. FATIGUE

Fatigue levels:

Rested ↓ Tired ↓ Exhausted ↓ Collapsed

Fatigue affects:

- combat;
 - dialogue;
 - travel;
 - learning.
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19. HUNGER

Hunger levels:

Satisfied ↓ Hungry ↓ Starving

Effects:

- weakness;
 - disease risk;
 - poor decisions.
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20. AGE

Characters age.

Age affects:

- attributes;
 - reputation;
 - health.
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21. MEMORY

The player character also has memory.

The game remembers:

- promises;
 - enemies;
 - friends;
 - crimes;
 - achievements;
 - failures.
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22. KNOWLEDGE

The character only knows what they learned.

Examples:

Unknown language: cannot read.

Unknown creature: cannot identify.

Unknown disease: cannot diagnose.

23. SOCIAL STATUS

Possible status:

- nobody;
 - known traveler;
 - respected citizen;
 - noble;
 - criminal;
 - legend.
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24. LEGENDARY STATUS

Legendary status is earned through:

- deeds;
- stories;
- reputation.

Not through levels.

25. CORE RULE

The player does not become stronger because of experience.

The player becomes stronger because they learn, survive, adapt, and change.